JAMES DARRIGO

FULL STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Florida | Remote | 516-305-1251 | James.darrigo29@gmail.com | LinkedIn.com/in/jamesdarrigo29 | GitHub.com/jamesdarrigo29

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full Stack Software Engineer with 5+ years of professional experience building scalable web applications and APIs using PHP (Symfony, Laravel), Python (Django, FastAPI), React, and Next.js, with strong database expertise across MySQL, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB, and hands-on AWS deployment experience. Experienced in backend architecture, frontend development, database design, API integrations, synchronous/asynchronous processing, performance optimization, and cloud environments. Hands-on experience developing AI-powered applications using LLMs, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), vector search, and Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, including building citation-grounded AI systems with safeguards against hallucinations. Experienced in Agile collaboration, developer mentoring, and delivering production software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML, CSS
Backend: Symfony, Laravel, Django, FastAPI, Node.js
Frontend: React, Redux, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, jQuery
AI: AI-Assisted Development, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Tooling, Claude
Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Cloud & DevOps: AWS (ECS, RDS, Lambda, S3), Microsoft Azure, Docker, CI/CD, Git
Architecture & Development: API Design, Model-View-Controller (MVC), System Integration, Asynchronous Processing, Message Queues (RabbitMQ), Performance Optimization, Code Review, Agile/Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Scout / *Remote* / Full-Time
Full Stack Web Developer | Dec 2023 – Sep 2026

- Architect and maintain scalable REST APIs using PHP and Symfony for Scout's clinical trial support platform, deployed via AWS ECS, supporting 100K+ daily API requests in a HIPAA/SOC2 compliant production environment while improving average API response times by 30% through backend and query optimization.
- Build and maintain React frontend-application with TypeScript and Redux, developing API-driven features and responsive interfaces while improving page-load performance, as well as designing and creating custom React components.
- Spearheaded the end-to-end backend development of the Scout DtS virtual payment card management platform; building REST API endpoints, service-layer logic, database queries, request and approval workflows, and Emburse payment integration to support the full card lifecycle from issuance and limit-increase approvals through closure.
- Contributed to migrating clinical trial report generation from synchronous Symfony API requests to an asynchronous workflow using RabbitMQ and AWS Lambda, drastically improving application responsiveness and reducing API load.
- Design and optimize MongoDB data models and queries with Doctrine ORM to support high-volume backend services and improve data retrieval performance.
- Develop secure API integrations handling sensitive clinical and patient data, implementing authentication, authorization, input validation, error handling, reducing API error rates by 40%.
- Leverage Claude and AI-assisted development workflows for code generation, debugging, refactoring, documentation, and technical exploration, accelerating development while maintaining engineering, security, and code-review standards.

Contextual Code / *Remote* | Full-Time
Full Stack Web Developer | Jan 2023 – Dec 2023

- Engineered and maintained full-stack web applications for Florida state government agencies and enterprise clients using PHP, Laravel, Next.js, JavaScript, and Tailwind CSS within Agile/Scrum development teams.
- Designed and implemented RESTful APIs with PHP and Laravel, supporting decoupled frontend applications and improving data delivery performance by 40%.
- Integrated Ibexa CMS with headless frontend architectures, developing API integrations that reduced response latency by 35% and improved overall application performance.
- Built reusable React components within Next.js applications using Tailwind CSS, powering responsive, decoupled frontend interfaces for enterprise clients.
- Designed and optimized MySQL databases through relational schema design, complex queries, indexing, and version-controlled schema migrations, supporting scalable applications under high-traffic production workloads.

Restrung / *Remote* | Freelance
Full Stack Web Developer | May 2021 – Jan 2023

- Built and maintained a full-stack e-commerce platform from the ground up using JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap, Python, and Django, delivering responsive customer-facing experiences across desktop and mobile.
- Architected Django backend services for authentication, business logic, dynamic content delivery, and core e-commerce workflows.
- Designed, provisioned, and configured PostgreSQL on AWS RDS for users, orders, and transactions, optimizing database schemas and query execution while maintaining transactional integrity during concurrent order processing.
- Built internal administrative dashboards for order, user, and inventory management, reducing manual processing time by 50% and streamlining day-to-day operations.
- Integrated Stripe payment processing into the checkout flow, implementing secure transaction handling, order confirmation, and payment error handling across the end-to-end purchase lifecycle.

EDUCATION

Associate's Degree in Applied Sciences | Aug. 2019 - May 2021
City University of New York — Queens, NY

FEATURED PROJECTS

Lokt — AI Privacy Policy Analyzer | lokt.dev | github.com/Jamesdarrigo29/lokt

FastAPI · Python · RAG · LLMs · PostgreSQL · Docker

- Built Lokt, a full-stack RAG application that ingests company privacy policies (PDF or live URL) and generates a structured attribute dashboard plus a citation-grounded chatbot, using FastAPI, React/TypeScript, Postgres with pgvector, and the Anthropic and OpenAI APIs.
- Designed a synchronous ingestion pipeline (PDF/HTML → Markdown → chunk → embed → vector store → LLM attribute extraction) with no separate worker or queue infrastructure, keeping the architecture simple while handling document conversion, web scraping (via Playwright/trafilatura), and semantic search in a single request.
- Implemented a four-layer hallucination-prevention system for the chat feature — retrieval-confidence gating, grounding instructions with prompt-injection guards, zero-temperature responses, and citation validation against actually-retrieved passages — to ensure answers are traceable to source text.
- Added resilient scraping fallbacks (structured error codes, a dedicated ScrapeBlockedError, PDF-upload alternative) so the product degrades gracefully when target sites block automated access.
- Instrumented every chat exchange with retrieval metadata and similarity scores in a dedicated logging table, laying groundwork for offline faithfulness evaluation without requiring additional infrastructure.